

DATA BACKUP POLICY

Revision: 1.0

Issue Status: A

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Revision History

#	Version	Release Date	Description of the Change	Created/ Modified by	Approved by
1	1.0	16-Sep-2024	Initial	Kalpana	Gayathri

Review History

#	Version	Review Date	Description	Created/ Modified by	Reviewed by
1	1.0	12-Sep-2024	Initial	Kalpana	Gayathri

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Purpose:

The purpose of this data backup policy is to establish guidelines for the backup and recovery of critical business data in order to ensure the continuity of operations and compliance with SOC 2 requirements, which emphasize security, availability, processing integrity, confidentiality, and privacy.

Scope

This policy applies to all systems, services, applications, databases, and data repositories managed by the organization that contain sensitive or critical data subject to SOC 2 compliance. It includes, but is not limited to:

- Customer data
- Business-critical data
- Financial records
- Employee data
- Operational data

Objectives

- Ensure the **availability** of critical data in the event of hardware failure, data corruption, natural disaster, or cyberattack.
- Protect **data integrity** by ensuring that all backups are secure, complete, and recoverable.
- Safeguard the **confidentiality** of data by employing encryption and secure storage solutions.
- Ensure regular and documented testing of backup and restore processes.

Roles and Responsibilities

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- **Chief Information Security Officer (CISO):** Oversees the execution of this policy and ensures compliance with SOC 2 standards.
- **IT Support Team:** Responsible for configuring, monitoring, and maintaining backup systems. They ensure that backups are executed as per schedule, stored securely, and are recoverable. Assists with implementing and troubleshooting backup processes and systems.
- **Internal Auditors:** Periodically review the backup logs, audit trails, and documentation to ensure adherence to this policy.

Backup Frequency

Daily Backups

- In most of the the client projects, the client IT team takes care of data backup. Incase Ideas2IT handles the infrastructure for the client, critical data, such as production databases, customer information, and operational logs, must be backed up **daily**.
- These backups should include full backups of databases, file systems, and applications deemed mission-critical.

Weekly Backups

- In most of the the client projects, the client IT team takes care of data backup. Incase Ideas2IT handles the infrastructure for the client all non-critical data (development and test environments) should be backed up **weekly**.
- Full system snapshots must also be taken weekly to ensure total data integrity.

Monthly Archival

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- In most of the the client projects, the client IT team takes care of data backup. Incase Ideas2IT handles the infrastructure for the client, a **monthly** full backup of all critical systems and data should be retained as an archive for long-term storage.
- These backups will be retained for **7 years** or as required by industry regulations or client contracts.

Backup Storage

On-site Storage

- **Daily backups** will be stored in an **on-premise secure server** or data center with restricted access to authorized personnel only.
- The on-site backup solution should include redundant systems to prevent data loss due to hardware failures.

Off-site Storage

- **Weekly and monthly backups** must be stored off-site using a third-party cloud storage service or a secondary physical data center located in a geographically diverse location.
- Off-site backups ensure that the organization is protected from local disasters, such as fires, floods, or power outages.

Backup Encryption

- All backup data must be encrypted **at rest** and **in transit** using strong encryption standards (e.g., AES-256) to ensure confidentiality.
- Access to encryption keys must be limited to authorized personnel only, and the key management process must adhere to SOC 2 standards for secure key

Retention Policy

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- **Daily backups** must be retained for a minimum of **30 days**.
- **Weekly backups** must be retained for **6 months**.
- **Monthly backups** must be retained for **7 years** or as dictated by contractual or regulatory obligations.
- Backup data that is no longer required must be securely deleted in a manner that ensures it is unrecoverable (e.g., by using data sanitization tools).

Backup Testing

- **Quarterly testing** of the backup and restore process is mandatory to ensure the integrity and availability of backups. This includes:
 - Performing test restores on a sampling of critical and non-critical systems.
 - Verifying that data restores correctly without corruption.
 - Documenting the test results and addressing any issues identified during testing.

Monitoring and Reporting

- Automated monitoring tools must be implemented to track the success or failure of backup jobs.
- Daily backup reports must be reviewed by the Backup Administrator to ensure backups are successful.
- Any failed backup jobs must be investigated and resolved within **24 hours**.
- Monthly and quarterly reports on the backup status should be shared with IT leadership and reviewed for continuous improvement.

Disaster Recovery

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- The **disaster recovery plan** (DRP) must include specific details on how backup data will be accessed and restored in the event of a data loss event.
- A recovery time objective (RTO) and recovery point objective (RPO) should be clearly defined for each system, with procedures in place to meet these objectives.
 - **RTO:** The maximum allowable downtime for critical systems (e.g., 4 hours).
 - **RPO:** The maximum acceptable amount of data loss (e.g., no more than 1

Access Control and Auditing

- Backup data must be **restricted** to authorized personnel only, and access must be controlled using role-based access control (RBAC).
- An audit trail must be maintained for all backup and recovery operations, including:
 - Who performed the backup/restore.
 - What data was backed up/restored.
 - When the backup/restore was performed.
 - The results of the backup/restore.

Compliance and Review

- The backup policy will be reviewed **annually** or whenever significant changes to systems or data processes occur.
- Internal and external auditors will assess compliance with SOC 2 standards and ensure that all backup processes align with the organization's security, availability, confidentiality, and privacy principles.

Incident Response

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- In the event of a **backup failure**, the IT Support Team/Client IT Team will collaborate to:
 - Investigate the cause of the failure.
 - Restore the most recent successful backup.
 - Implement measures to prevent future failures.
 - Document the incident for future reference.

Review and Continuous Improvement:

This policy must be reviewed annually to ensure alignment with evolving business needs, technological advances, and updates to SOC 2 compliance requirements. Continuous improvement processes should be applied to address new threats and vulnerabilities in the software development and acquisition process.